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Arbitration

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Meet The Faculty Members

Dr Osei Bonsu Dickson FCIMArb

*CIMA World Fellow (London) and Professor
of Practice in International Arbitration*

Dr. Osei Bonsu Dickson is a top-tier international lawyer with expertise in cybersecurity law, international commercial arbitration, maritime strategy, national security law and investor-state dispute settlement. He is a CIMA World Fellow (London) and Professor of Practice in International Arbitration. He is currently enrolled on the Chartered Institute of Arbitrators (UK)'s Global Diploma in International Commercial Arbitration at University of Oxford. He is Course Director of the Oxford-Africa Forum on International Arbitration.

Dr Dickson is a Member of New York State Dispute Resolution Association (NYSDRA), the London Court of International Arbitration (LCIA), the Ghana Association of Certified Mediators and Arbitrators (GHACMA) and the Public Law Committee of the Commonwealth Law Association. He is a 2024 Harvard Berkman Klein Speaker on AI, Technology and Law. He has been ranked #1 by the 6th National Communication Awards, and was recipient of the prestigious 2024 Distinguished Cybersecurity Personality of the Year. He is also ranked on 2024 Thinkers 360's Global Top 100 List. He is also Founding Partner, Off-Counsel, and Chair of International Dispute Resolution at Lex Mundus & Cencla PRUC with affiliates in Italy and Malawi.

He has served as Chief Legal Advisor to the National Security Council Secretariat, Director, Legal; Director, Policy; Legal & Regulatory Director at Expresso Telecom Group; and Chief Counsel at US multinational, Sanford Health (Ghana) advising on complex investor state dispute settlement, commercial mediation and national security, maritime and cybersecurity matters over the last 20 years. He is also the immediate Past President of In-House Lawyers at the Ghana Bar Association, as well as a past member of the General Council of the Ghana Bar Association.

He has authored five books and is a sitting Board Member of the Financial Intelligence Center, the Ghana Boundary Commission and Board Chair of the Center for Counselling and Legal Aid. He is a part-time Lecturer at University of Ghana School of Law, and is a noted speaker and panel expert at several world-leading conferences on cybersecurity, national security and international arbitration in the United States, Europe, the Middle East and Africa. His passion includes moot court competitions, having won the 1st Prize Award of the Ghana School of Law at the Supreme Court in 2004. Dr Dickson was educated at University of Ghana School of Law, Ghana School of Law, Rushford Business School and Harvard University.



Meet The Faculty Members

Marieke Witkamp FCIArb

*CIMA World Fellow (Ghana) and Professor of
Practice in International Arbitration*

Marieke Witkamp FCIArb is a Houston based international arbitrator with an LLM in Dutch and US Law and a Texas bar license. She also holds the CIArb Diploma in International Maritime Arbitration. Marieke has over 20 years of dispute resolution experience and a unique professional background. She is originally trained as a commercial judge in the Netherlands and became an international commercial and arbitration lawyer after moving abroad to the United States and the Middle East.

Marieke's areas of expertise are maritime, insurance, construction, energy law and post M&A disputes but she is comfortable with almost any contractual dispute that comes up. As a judge she had to deal with anything that entered her docket. Marieke is a hands-on arbitrator who takes her responsibility to start off a procedure in the best way possible and will take the necessary decisions to keep a procedure on track. She is often asked as chair as is very experienced in managing cases, leading hearings and writing fair and well-reasoned awards.



Meet The Faculty Members

Bobby Banson FCIMArb

Bobby Banson Esq., FCI Arb is described as a very dynamic and results-oriented legal practitioner. He is Founding Partner and Lead Consultant of Robert Smith Law Group where he spearheads the boutique law firm's businesses in Alternative Dispute Resolution, Investment Advisory, and Corporate Governance. With expertise in cross-border trade and investment, Bobby has provided legal services for national and multinational companies doing businesses in the West African sub-region across diverse industries including oil and gas, mining, manufacturing and retail, airline and aviation, construction, and real estate. Also, he has acted as Counsel for both businesses and governments in domestic and international arbitration.

Bobby's thought-leadership in transnational dispute management is seen in the speaker engagements he has done across the globe over the years at the invitation of the Chartered Institute of Arbitrators (CI Arb.), the Africa International Legal Awareness (AILA), and the SOAS Conferences on Arbitration in Africa. He also has numerous publications to his name. Some of his recent publications discuss the implementation requirements of the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA), the development of arbitration consciousness in Africa, and the enforcement of arbitral awards arising from international treaty agreements. Bobby is a lecturer in Civil Procedure at the Ghana School of Law.



Meet The Faculty Members

Nania Owusu Ankomah-Sackey FCIMArb

Nania is a litigation and arbitration practitioner and a Partner at Bentsi-Enchill, Letsa & Ankomah, a first-tier law firm in Ghana. She regularly advises and represents clients in various high-value litigation and arbitration disputes and is noted for her innovative approach to complex legal issues.

Nania serves as a Court member of the London Court of International Arbitration (LCIA) and is the President of the LCIA African Users' Council. She chairs the Ghana Chapter of the Chartered Institute of Arbitrators and is a member of the English Commercial Bar (COMBAR) Africa Committee. She is also involved with the ICC Commission on Arbitration & ADR and serves on the board of the Lagos Chamber of Commerce International Arbitration Centre.

As an arbitrator, Nania has experience in both domestic and international arbitrations in institutional and ad hoc proceedings. She has been appointed as sole arbitrator and co-arbitrator by institutions like the LCIA, ICC, and Ghana Arbitration Centre. Additionally, she is listed on CPR's Panels of Distinguished Neutrals and the Ghana ADR Hub List of Arbitrators. She has served as a Member of the Electronic Communications Tribunal of Ghana, a quasi-judicial body for appeals related to the regulation and licensing of telecommunications, television, and radio in Ghana.

Previously, she was Co-Chair of the Africa Arbitration Group of the IBA Arbitration Committee and served as Editor of its Newsletter. Nania contributes to training programs in arbitration and litigation, including the Remote Oral Advocacy Programme (ROAP EMEA: 2022 & 2024) by Delos Dispute Resolution.

She is recognized by Chambers and Partners, Who's Who Legal, and Legal 500 as a leading Dispute Resolution and Arbitration lawyer. Lawdragon included her in its 500 Global Litigators list in 2023 and 2024, and the Africa Arbitration Academy named her a Trailblazer in International Arbitration in 2024. She was also recognized as one of Africa's 30 Most Promising Arbitration Practitioners (2022) and one of the 50 Most Promising Arbitration Practitioners (2020) by the Africa Arbitration Academy.

Nania lectures in Alternative Dispute Resolution at the Ghana School of Law and is called to the bar in both England and Wales and in Ghana.



Meet The Faculty Members

Fahira Brodlija

CIMA World Fellow (Ghana) and Professor of Practice in International Arbitration

Fahira Brodlija is the Rule of Law Advisor for a regional GIZ legal reform project focusing on the reform of the legal framework for investment protection and investor-state dispute settlement in the Western Balkans.

Fahira is an adjunct lecturer at the International University of Sarajevo, and she frequently writes and speaks on topics related to ISDS reform, investment law and international dispute resolution more broadly.

Fahira is a tutor for the CiArb Diploma program, and guest lecturer at universities across Africa, Europe and the United States.

Fahira is a former Vis Moot participant and a coach of law faculties from Bosnia and Herzegovina and the region since 2016.

Fahira is a member of Association ARBITRI, and founder of the GEM diversity and mentorship program supporting young academics and practitioners in the field of international arbitration.



Meet The Faculty Members

Dr Abayomi Okubote FCIArb

CIMA World Fellow (Ghana) and Professor of Practice in International Arbitration

Dr Abayomi Okubote is a Professor of International Business Law at Loyalist College in Canada, Visiting Professor at the College of Law in Bowen University in Nigeria.

He has been featured in the Legal 500 Africa Arbitration Powerlist 2021 as “one of the thought leaders of arbitration in Africa” and by described by peers as “innovative and exceptional”, Abayomi is an International Arbitration Partner at Pensbury Attorneys & Solicitors – an arbitration boutique law firm in Nigeria. He has garnered circa 15 years’ experience in dispute resolution. He was part of the teams that represented multinational and domestic corporations in high profile commercial disputes and has advised government agencies on several cutting-edge projects in Africa. Beyond leading big-ticket mandates, the multiple award winner is the prime mover behind several important arbitration initiatives in Africa. He is the Founder of the Association of Young Arbitrators (AYA), the Executive Director of the Africa Arbitration Academy and is the Managing Editor of the African Journal of International Arbitration. Abayomi is an alumnus of Queen’s University in Canada, the University College London, Harvard Negotiation Institute, ICC Summer School, and the Paris Arbitration Academy. He has completed work programs in the London offices of Baker McKenzie LLP and 4-5 Gray’s Inn.

Abayomi has been appointed by the Nigerian courts and has sat as an arbitrator in several domestic and international arbitrations. He was recently appointed by the Nigerian court to chair an arbitral tribunal over a multi-Billion Naira construction dispute. His PhD project focused on developing a Model Law on Third-Party Funding in International Arbitration and received generous funding from different institutions including the \$40,000 scholarship award by the Centre for International Governance Innovation (CIGI) in Waterloo, Canada. This important research project was also nominated for the national round of the SSHRC Doctoral Scholarship in Canada.

Abayomi is a Professor of International Business Law at Loyalist College in Canada, a Visiting Professor at the College of Law in Bowen University in Nigeria, Tutor and Faculty Member at the CIArb Diploma in International Arbitration Programme at Oxford University in the United Kingdom. He is a Fellow of the Chartered Institute of Arbitrators, Court Member of the Lagos Chamber of Commerce International Arbitration Centre and is listed on panels at the Cairo Regional Centre for International Arbitration and the Nairobi Centre for International Arbitration. The H.R. Stuart Ryan Award Fellow has published several award-winning thought leadership materials. He is Co-chair of the Africa Committee for Greener Arbitration Pledge.



Meet The Faculty Members

Hasit Seth FCI Arb

*CIMA World Fellow (UAE) and Professor of
Practice in Dispute Resolution*

Hasit is an experienced international arbitrator, mediator and counsel with technology specialism. Counsel in arbitrations and courts. Licensed attorney in New York and India. 20+ years of experience in dispute resolution and business.



Meet The Faculty Members

Dr. Walid Ben Hamida

Dr. Walid BEN HAMIDA is a Professor of Law at the University of Lille, France. He was a member of the International Chamber of Commerce (ICC) Arbitration Court for 6 years.

He served as president of arbitral tribunal, sole arbitrator, co-arbitrator, expert witness and counsel in nearly 50 commercial and investment arbitrations under ICSID, ICC, OHADA and ad hoc rules. Dr. BEN HAMIDA has acted under a variety of applicable laws, including OHADA, American, Algerian, Belgian, Chinese, Egyptian, French, Iraqi, Ivorian, Qatari, Libyan, Malagasy, Mauritian, Saudi, Senegalese, Swiss, Tunisian, Turkish... He has particular experience in disputes in the following industries: Agency, Construction, Engineering, Corporate Law/M&A, Distribution, Franchising, Energy and Natural Resources, Finance and Banking, Infrastructure, Insurance, Investment, Joint Ventures/Consortia, Maritime, Sales, Purchases, Taxation, Tourism & Hospitality, Real Estate and Transport with a particular regional focus on Africa and the Arab Countries. Dr. BEN HAMIDA is also an appointed member of the ICSID Panel of conciliators and arbitrators and nominated arbitrator in the major arbitral institutions lists in the world (CCJA, CIETAC, CMAP, KIAC, VIAC..).

Dr. BENHAMIDA authored more than 150 publications in the Arabic, French and English languages. He cooperates with many international organisations on issues of ADR, International Trade, Investment and Business Law. He is a regular speaker at conferences, seminars, roundtables and other fora on topics regarding dispute settlement, and visiting professor in more than 70 countries

Rachel Haizel

Rachel is a lecturer at the University of Ghana School of Law and an Associate at Stobe Law. She holds an LLM in International Business Law from the London School of Economics and Political Science. She is a member of the Ghana Bar Association. Her areas of interest include International Commercial Litigation, Conflict of Laws, Contract Law and International Investment Law and Arbitration.



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